

Let's Have a Relay 2026

English version of Mutwenda text

By Danielle Dandylion

On a plateau, there was a sacred oasis called Susidse, and at this sacred oasis lived a farmer named Mubuku. A spirit named Myas, in the form of a white bird, found the vulture's flower. And so the spirit was going to poison the people who eat too much bird-flesh.

Myas perched upon the oasis plateau's hearth and watched. The farmer's children set fuel ablaze, and the fire grew tall. One child placed white birds around the fire. The older child beat a gamey bird near a palm tree. Myas forced the sky to thunder, but the lightning struck the tree. The bleeding bird cried out, and the older child screamed. The children ran towards the blackened, burnt palm tree. Myas made bird-cries as he flew away from them.

The farmer ran toward her children, calling to them. She saw that her children had eaten birds. The children begged Myas, and drank the sacred water of the oasis, so that the spirit might forgive them. The sky thundered above the tall trees. In the bright stream beneath the trees, Myas brought his dark datura to life.

Myas commanded a sacrifice. Mubuku, bringing mercy to her children, took the poison flower in her hand. The poisonous flower would kill the farmer, and Susidse would remain in peace.